



MSME & COOPERATIVES
**INCLUSIVE
GROWTH**
FORUM

**ECOSYSTEM COMPACT
& COMMITMENT
CHARTER LAUNCH**



**small business
development**

Department:
Small Business Development
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA



ECOSYSTEM COMPACT & COMMITMENT CHARTER LAUNCH

To commit, coordinate, and to convert
our shared intentions into action.
Turning the dialogue into delivery –
moving from dialogue to action!



1. This Ecosystem Compact is designed to unite all ecosystem actors behind one purpose. To drive inclusive, sustainable, and scalable growth for MSMEs and cooperatives across South Africa.

This Compact commits to:

- Formalising strategic partnerships that bring together government, corporates, DFIs, donors, and ecosystem enablers.
- Announcing new co-created initiatives that address the real constraints MSMEs face – from market access and finance gaps to capability challenges.
- Aligning efforts with national and district-level priorities so the work is coordinated and not duplicated.
- Adopting common principles and a strong governance architecture that ensures accountability and transparency.
- Establishing a quarterly Ecosystem Forum, convened by SEDFA so that progress is tracked, obstacles are unblocked, and collective wins are celebrated.

2. Shared Objectives (2026–2029)

- Market Access: Increase MSME/co op participation in public and private value chains.
- Finance Access: Expand fit for purpose financial instruments (incl. blended finance and guarantees).
- Capabilities: Improve productivity/readiness via targeted BDS, incubation, and standards.
- Localisation & Inclusion: Anchor delivery at district level with a bias for women, youth, and township/rural enterprises.
- Data & Learning: Build a shared evidence-based and iterate interventions based on what works.

3. Guiding Principles

In endorsing this Ecosystem Compact, we emphasise the principles that will guide the collective action:

- Action, not symbolism – We prioritise tangible results over announcements.
- Materiality – We commit to interventions with real and measurable impact.
- Coordination, not duplication – We leverage each other's strengths to avoid working in silos.



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- Transparency and accountability – Progress, commitments, and outcomes will be openly shared.
- Fair participation and inclusion – Township, rural, women and youth-led enterprises remain central to this mission.
- Ethical, responsible collaboration – We uphold integrity, good governance, and respect for commercially sensitive information.

These principles define working together consistently, coherently, and collaboratively.

4. Commitment Charter

Each ecosystem actor makes clear commitments within their sphere of influence.

Government and Public Institutions commit to:

- Expanding market access through procurement reforms, supplier inclusion, and reduced payment cycles.
- Providing enabling infrastructure, regulatory support, and district-level capacity.

DFIs and Financial Institutions commit to:

- Deploying catalytic finance that is accessible, appropriate, and aligned to district and sector priorities.
- Innovating financial products — including blended finance — and co funding high impact initiatives.

Corporate and SOE partners commit to:

- Opening supply chains to MSMEs and cooperatives.
- Providing technical standards, capability lift, and supplier development support.
- Exploring off take agreements and long-term market opportunities.

Donors and Development Partners commit to:

- Funding catalytic pilots and scale ups.
- Strengthening evidence, measurement, and learning systems.

Ecosystem Enablers, SEDFA, NGOs, Accelerators, and Academia commit to:

- Delivering high-quality, outcomes based support to MSMEs.
- Sharing data and insights that help us learn, adapt, and improve.

These commitments create the enabling environment necessary for inclusive, sustainable, and scalable growth of MSME and cooperatives growth.

Moving from dialogue to action, from fragmented efforts to coordinated delivery, from good intentions to accountable, measurable outcomes.

Invite all signatories to continue this journey with purpose, urgency, and unity.

To proceed with the formal signing of the Ecosystem Compact & Commitment Charter and the public affirmation of commitments for 2026–2029.